

There is also a compelling value proposition. Experiencing the cuisine of an acclaimed international chef in India can be considerably cheaper than travelling to Europe, Japan or Latin America, for a meal at the chef's own restaurant.

Sanghvi recalls that when Bottura cooked in New Delhi, two large tables were occupied by guests who had travelled specifically from Raipur and Hyderabad.

Vaibhav Bahl, Co-Founder of Conosh, another company bringing international chefs to India, has seen a similar evolution. When Conosh began organising culinary experiences, considerable effort went into explaining to customers why they should pay a premium to eat food prepared by an acclaimed chef.

Today, that awareness already exists. "Earlier we had to really reach out to people and convince them to come for this meal. Now, it's more demand-led, because people are aware," he says.

Conosh invites around 25 chefs annually, organising pop-ups across cities including Mumbai, Delhi, Bengaluru, Hyderabad, Pune and Jaipur. Prices typically range from ₹10,000 to ₹50,000, with ₹10,000-15,000 being the more

GASTRO MOMENTS

- CONSUMERS ARE WILLING TO SPEND EXTRAORDINARY SUMS FOR AN EVENING WITH AN INTERNATIONALLY ACCLAIMED CHEF
- LUXURY BRANDS AND CORPORATE HOUSES ARE TREATING ACCESS TO EXCLUSIVE CULINARY EXPERIENCES AS A REWARD FOR VALUED CUSTOMERS
- SOME OF INDIA'S MOST SOUGHT-AFTER DINING EXPERIENCES ARE LOCATED AWAY FROM CONVENTIONAL RESTAURANT DISTRICTS
- A MEAL PREPARED BY A CELEBRATED CHEF IS NOT SOMETHING THAT CAN BE REPLICATED, ITS APPEAL LIES PARTLY IN ITS FLEETING NATURE